❋ Swordfiend

-"I'm sure we can settle this in a civilized manner."

Description:

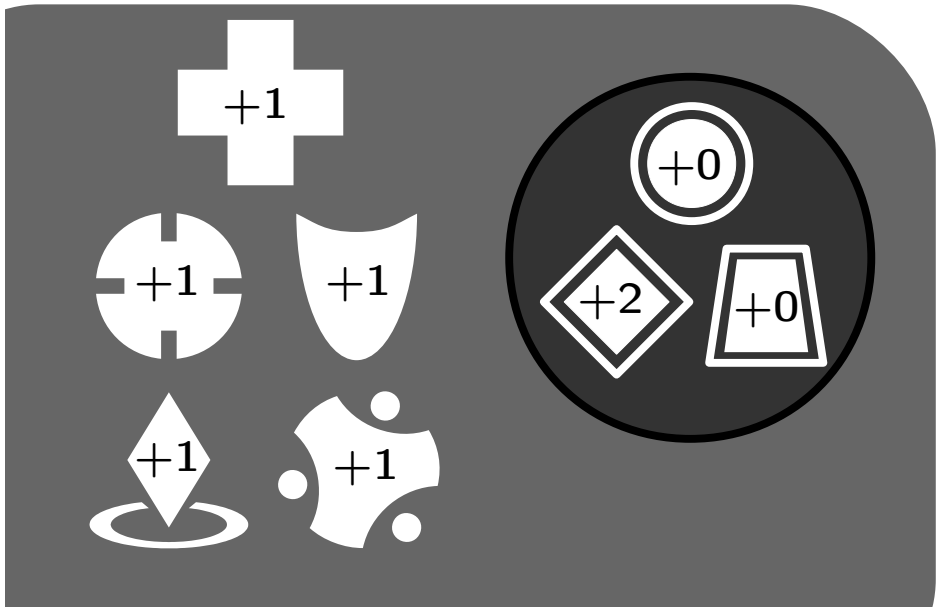
Long ago, combat was an art. Heroes were brave, relying on skill and speed rather than the pricetag of their weaponry. Even now, a sharpened blade is worthy of respect, piercing armour and shield modules alike.

Strategy:

Swordfiends throw themselves into the thick of combat, sacrificing defence in exchange for extra damage and battlefield control. Combine with a more defensive class such as Predator to make yourself more durable in combat. Combine with Freerunner or other logistical classes to maximise your position based abilities.

Starting Bonuses:

- ☐ +1 attack when using a sword.
- ☐ +3 Agility And Dexterity
- ☐ +1 Strength, Piloting and History
- ☐ +1 Deceive, Manipulate and Entertain
- ☐ **Equipment:** 2d8 fencer's blade.
- ☐ **Equipment:** Fine clothes.
- ☐ **Rules note:** Many of the following feats refer to a "sword". By this we mean any long piercing weapon, hence a Predator's barbs or sharpened stick qualify, but a short dagger does not. If in doubt, talk to your GM.



Character details:

Answer one (or more) of the following backstory details.

When fighting, what genre of sound-track do you imagine? _____

Where did you get your current sword. Is it a family heirloom? Stolen from pirates? The results of a particularly good shopping trip? _____

What do you aspire to? What skill or character trait do you most admire in each of your teammates (if any)? _____

Are you a celebrity on any "HeroVid" networks? Do you have an audience? A reputation? Is that something you aspire to? Or something you plan to avoid? What do you think of "Celebrity heroes"? _____

Draw your sword in the gap below:

Tempo

You have a new stat, **Tempo**, representing your grace and flow in combat.

While wielding a sword, each point of Tempo grants +1 ATK.

At the start of combat, and whenever you deal **or** receive damage, your Tempo is reset to zero. Tempo increases by 1 point whenever you roll an attack or defence roll which results in a miss, up to a max of six.

Effects which break your momentum other than damage may also break your tempo, at GM discretion. Only one tempo can be gained per attack/defence, regardless of the number of dice actually rolled.

En Garde!

You start each combat with +2 tempo.
Each point of Tempo now grants +1 REF.

Parry

While wielding a sword, each point of Tempo now grants +1 DEF against all attackers within your melee range (hence, melee attacks, and ranged attackers at point blank range)

Riposte

Requires: Parry + Feint

Each point of tempo grants +1 crit. def. range. If you deal damage outside of your turn (such as during a counter attack), this damage no longer resets your tempo to zero.

Thrust

Every point of tempo now grants you +1 **damage** with a sword.

Lunge

Requires: Thrust + Forced Move

Every point of **tempo** now grants you +1 critical hit range whenever attacking with a sword.

Banter

Gain a +2 bonus on all social skill checks used during combat. (For example when putting on a show, reading an opponent, or trying to convince an opponent they have no hope of defeating you.)

Fencer's Etiquette

Requires: one Swordfiend feats

Wherever you go, you know the proper etiquette for challenging enemies to a duel, no knowledge check is needed.

You know the rules of such duels, and gain +5 to all people reading checks to determine if the rules are being subverted.

You gain a +2 attack and defence bonus when taking part in duels.

Displacement

Requires: En Garde, Fulcrum

Whenever you take damage, you lose only one point of tempo, rather than being reset to zero.

Patinando

Requires: one swordfiend feats

While wielding a sword, increase your AoO range by two meters: you may spend a reaction to dash 2 meters and THEN make an attack against an opponent who given you an opening.

Accelerando

At the start of your turn, if tempo is 2 or higher, gain an extra reaction for this round. If Tempo is 4 or higher, gain **another** extra reaction each turn.

Crescendo

Requires: Accelerando + Patinando

When your Tempo reaches 6, you may **immediately** take a full turn, ignoring the usual initiative order. At the end of that turn, return to the initiative order where you left off.

Finesse

When using bladed weapon, after rolling damage, you may choose to reduce the damage dealt. (EG, if you roll 14, you might choose to reduce to 6). Your target will be acutely aware of how much damage they *could* have taken.

Forced Move

Requires: one Swordfiend feat

Whenever you use a sword to attack a character, they must choose to either move one step in the direction of your choosing OR grant you +2 attack and +2 critical hit range.

Fulcrum

Requires: one Swordfiend feat

Whenever you are adjacent to an enemy, if you are wielding a sword you may manipulate them so as to maximise the chance that incoming fire hits them rather than you.

Your allies gain +2 ATK on all ranged attacks against them. If any of *their* allies fire upon you, increase the attackers critical failure range by 2 (and such failures indicate that they have hit your foe).

Back to the Wall

Requires: one Swordfiend feat

Whenever you have a solid obstacle behind you, you gain +2 defence.

Whenever you attack a target with a solid obstacle behind them, gain +2 attack.

Feint

Requires: one Swordfiend feat

Whenever there are two enemies within reach, you may roll a single sword attack, prompting both to roll defence rolls. Your GM will tell you all defence scores (after applying bonuses), and you may choose who your attack is aimed at based on these numbers.